

DAD'S CODE · PRINTABLE DECK

Dad & Me

100 conversation cards to spark real
talks with your kids.



A printable card deck by **Jamie Wigg**

Present, not perfect.

A note from Jamie ▪

Here's the thing I wish someone had told me earlier: **the best talks happen sideways.** Not across a table with a "so, how was your day?" that gets a shrug. They happen in the car at traffic lights, at bedtime with the light off, on a muddy walk when nobody's really looking at each other.

Kids open up when the pressure's off. A good question, dropped in at the right moment, does more than any lecture ever will. You don't need to be clever or have the answers — you just need to be curious about the small person in front of you.

These 100 cards are the questions I keep coming back to. Some are silly, some go deep, and a few will surprise you with where they lead. Pull one, ask it, and then — this is the important bit — really listen. You'll learn things about your kid you'd never have thought to ask.

You don't have to get it perfect. You just have to show up and be there.

— Jamie

How to use the deck ▪

There's no right way. Keep the cards somewhere handy and reach for one when the moment's right:

- 1 At dinner.** Pull one card and everyone answers — grown-ups too. Fair's fair.
- 2 In the car.** Hand the deck to whoever's in the back and let them pick. Side-by-side beats face-to-face.
- 3 At bedtime.** One quiet question as the lights go down. End the day on a real conversation.
- 4 Follow the thread.** If an answer opens a door, walk through it. Ask "why?" and "what else?" There's no rush to the next card.

Tip: print double-sided card stock, cut along the dashed lines, and pop them in a jar or tin.

Silly & Fun 18 cards

Daft, easy openers to get everyone laughing and talking.

SILLY & FUN

01

If you could be any animal for a day, what would you be and why?

SILLY & FUN

02

If our family started a band, what would we be called and what would you play?

SILLY & FUN

03

What's the silliest thing you've ever seen me do?

SILLY & FUN

04

If you could eat only one food for the rest of your life, what would it be?

SILLY & FUN

05

What would you do all day if you woke up and you were the grown-up?

SILLY & FUN

06

If you could give yourself a superpower, what would it be and how would you use it?

SILLY & FUN

07

What's the funniest word you can think of right now?

SILLY & FUN

08

If our pet could talk for one minute, what do you think it would say?

SILLY & FUN

09

What would you name a new colour that nobody has ever seen?

SILLY & FUN

10

If you could swap places with anyone for a day, who would it be?

SILLY & FUN

11

What's the weirdest sandwich you could invent? What's in it?

SILLY & FUN

12

If you had a robot to do one job for you, what job would it do?

SILLY & FUN

13

What's the best joke you know? Tell it to me.

SILLY & FUN

14

If you could make one rule everyone in the world had to follow, what would it be?

SILLY & FUN

15

If your shoes could take you anywhere right now, where would you go?

SILLY & FUN

16

What sound makes you laugh every single time you hear it?

SILLY & FUN

17

If you could turn invisible for an hour, what's the first thing you'd do?

SILLY & FUN

18

What's something you're really good at that might surprise people?

Feelings 18 cards

Gentle questions that help kids name what's going on inside.

FEELINGS

19

What's something that made you feel proud this week?

FEELINGS

20

What does it feel like in your body when you're really happy?

FEELINGS

21

When you're worried about something, what helps you feel better?

FEELINGS

22

Is there anything that's been bothering you lately that you haven't told me?

FEELINGS

23

What's something that makes you feel brave?

FEELINGS

24

When was the last time you felt really calm and happy?

FEELINGS

25

What do you do when you feel angry? Does it help?

FEELINGS

26

Who do you go to when you feel sad, and why them?

FEELINGS**27**

What's something that's been a bit tricky for you lately?

FEELINGS**28**

When do you feel the most like yourself?

FEELINGS**29**

Is there a feeling you find hard to talk about?

FEELINGS**30**

What's something kind someone did for you that you still remember?

FEELINGS**31**

When you make a mistake, how do you usually feel afterwards?

FEELINGS**32**

What makes you feel really loved?

FEELINGS**33**

Is there something you wish I understood better about you?

FEELINGS**34**

What's a worry you used to have that doesn't bother you anymore?

FEELINGS**35**

When something exciting is coming up, how do you feel waiting for it?

FEELINGS**36**

What's one thing that always cheers you up on a hard day?

Big Questions 16 cards

The thinky ones — about people, fairness and how the world works.

BIG QUESTIONS

37

What do you think makes someone a good friend?

BIG QUESTIONS

38

What does being brave actually mean to you?

BIG QUESTIONS

39

Is it ever okay to break a rule? When?

BIG QUESTIONS

40

What do you think the word "fair" really means?

BIG QUESTIONS

41

If you could ask anyone in history one question, who and what?

BIG QUESTIONS

42

What makes a person kind?

BIG QUESTIONS

43

Do you think grown-ups always know what they're doing?

BIG QUESTIONS

44

What's something you believe is true that some people might disagree with?

BIG QUESTIONS**45**

How do you know when you can trust someone?

BIG QUESTIONS**46**

What does it mean to be brave when no one is watching?

BIG QUESTIONS**47**

If everyone in the world could learn one thing, what should it be?

BIG QUESTIONS**48**

What's the difference between being clever and being wise?

BIG QUESTIONS**49**

Why do you think people sometimes find it hard to say sorry?

BIG QUESTIONS**50**

What's something you think is worth standing up for?

BIG QUESTIONS**51**

If you could change one rule at school, what would it be and why?

BIG QUESTIONS**52**

What do you think makes a happy life?

Memories 16 cards

Looking back together — the moments that stuck with you both.

MEMORIES

53

What's your favourite thing we've ever done together?

MEMORIES

54

What's the earliest thing you can remember?

MEMORIES

55

What's a day you wish you could live again?

MEMORIES

56

What's the best holiday or trip we've been on?

MEMORIES

57

What's something that always makes you laugh when you remember it?

MEMORIES

58

What's your favourite thing about your bedroom or our home?

MEMORIES

59

Who's someone you've met who you'll never forget?

MEMORIES

60

What's a tradition we do that you hope we never stop doing?

MEMORIES**61**

What's the best birthday you've ever had?

MEMORIES**62**

What's a smell or song that reminds you of something special?

MEMORIES**63**

What's the bravest thing you've ever done?

MEMORIES**64**

What's a time you were really proud of someone in our family?

MEMORIES**65**

What's a small ordinary day that you still think about?

MEMORIES**66**

What's the funniest thing that's happened at school?

MEMORIES**67**

What's something we did this year that you want to do again?

MEMORIES**68**

If you made a photo album of just happy moments, what would be on page one?

Dreams 16 cards

Where their imagination and hopes for the future want to go.

DREAMS

69

If you could fix one thing in the world, what would it be?

DREAMS

70

What do you dream about being or doing when you're older?

DREAMS

71

If you could travel anywhere in the world, where would you go first?

DREAMS

72

What's something brand new you'd love to learn how to do?

DREAMS

73

If you could invent something to help people, what would it do?

DREAMS

74

What kind of grown-up do you hope you'll be?

DREAMS

75

If you could build your dream home, what's the one room it must have?

DREAMS

76

What's an adventure you really want us to go on one day?

DREAMS**77**

If you could be famous for one thing, what would you want it to be?

DREAMS**78**

What's a goal you're quietly working towards right now?

DREAMS**79**

If you could meet your future self, what would you want to ask them?

DREAMS**80**

What would make next year an amazing year for you?

DREAMS**81**

If you could give every kid in the world one thing, what would it be?

DREAMS**82**

What's a place you'd love to see in real life that you've only seen in pictures?

DREAMS**83**

If you could spend a whole day doing anything you wanted, what would the day look like?

DREAMS**84**

What's something you hope never changes about our family?

Would You Rather 16 cards

Quick-fire choices — always ask "why did you pick that?"

WOULD YOU RATHER

85

Would you rather be able to fly or be invisible?

WOULD YOU RATHER

86

Would you rather have a pet dragon or a pet dinosaur?

WOULD YOU RATHER

87

Would you rather it always be summer or always be winter?

WOULD YOU RATHER

88

Would you rather be the funniest person you know or the kindest?

WOULD YOU RATHER

89

Would you rather explore deep space or the deep sea?

WOULD YOU RATHER

90

Would you rather only ever eat pizza or only ever eat ice cream?

WOULD YOU RATHER

91

Would you rather have a time machine that only goes back, or only goes forward?

WOULD YOU RATHER

92

Would you rather be really tall or really tiny?

WOULD YOU RATHER**93**

Would you rather talk to animals or speak every language in the world?

WOULD YOU RATHER**94**

Would you rather live by the sea or up in the mountains?

WOULD YOU RATHER**95**

Would you rather always win but on your own, or sometimes lose but with friends?

WOULD YOU RATHER**96**

Would you rather have a magic paintbrush or a magic notebook?

WOULD YOU RATHER**97**

Would you rather be an amazing singer or an amazing dancer?

WOULD YOU RATHER**98**

Would you rather never feel cold or never feel too hot?

WOULD YOU RATHER**99**

Would you rather have a treehouse or an underground den?

WOULD YOU RATHER**100**

Would you rather give the best presents or always get the best presents?